

6 Machine Ethics Quiz ANS

1. Which description fits "standards" as the deck contrasts them with "rules" in law?

- A) Laws written specifically to govern AI systems only
- B) Flexible statements that allow proportional responses
- C) Informal moral intuitions that carry no legal force at all
- D) Rigid instructions that reduce interpretation problems

ANS: B) Flexible statements that allow proportional responses

2. What is "gaming" in the discussion of law and AI?

- A) AIs taking short, open-ended instructions too literally and misreading what was meant
- B) AIs refusing to follow any of the rules that they have been given by developers
- C) Developers testing a model against a standard benchmark before its public release
- D) AIs playing the system of rules to their advantage in undesirable ways

ANS: D) AIs playing the system of rules to their advantage in undesirable ways

3. Which two problems does the deck give for relying on law alone to guide AI?

- A) Law is too moral in its content, and it ignores economic concerns
- B) Law is too specific to apply, and it changes too quickly to enforce
- C) Law is kept secret from the public, and it applies only to corporations
- D) Law is silent in many areas, and some laws clash with human morals

ANS: D) Law is silent in many areas, and some laws clash with human morals

4. How does the deck define "reasonable care"?

- A) The caution an ordinary, prudent person would use to avoid foreseeable harm to others
- B) The maximum level of caution that is technically possible for a company to achieve
- C) Following every instruction that a user gives to the system without any exception
- D) Avoiding every possible source of legal liability that the company could face

ANS: A) The caution an ordinary, prudent person would use to avoid foreseeable harm to others

5. What was the central dispute about the COMPAS software?

- A) Alleged excessive accuracy versus the counterclaim that the software was too cheap to maintain
- B) Alleged use only in healthcare versus the counterclaim that it was used only in schools
- C) Alleged bias against African Americans versus the counterclaim that it was calibrated and therefore fair
- D) Alleged copyright violation versus the counterclaim that the software was open source

ANS: C) Alleged bias against African Americans versus the counterclaim that it was calibrated and therefore fair

6. Which fairness definition requires the false positive rate and false negative rate to be equal across groups?

- A) Counterfactual fairness
- B) Equalized odds
- C) Statistical parity
- D) Calibration

ANS: B) Equalized odds

7. What does the impossibility theorem for AI fairness state?

- A) No AI system can ever be allowed to make a decision that affects a person
- B) Fairness can always be achieved simply by collecting a great deal more training data
- C) The three classic definitions of fairness are usually contradictory, so no predictor satisfies them all
- D) All of the classic fairness definitions turn out to be logically equivalent to each other

ANS: C) The three classic definitions of fairness are usually contradictory, so no predictor satisfies them all

8. According to the deck, which is a weakness of social approaches to improving fairness (such as participatory design)?

- A) They cannot involve the stakeholders affected
- B) They fail to address any bad outcomes at all
- C) They are more subjective, expensive, and difficult
- D) They work only for a single narrow domain

ANS: C) They are more subjective, expensive, and difficult

9. Which is among the conditions listed for the First Fundamental Theorem of Welfare Economics?

- A) A single seller is big enough to set prices alone
- B) Externalities are common in consumption
- C) The state does not enforce contracts
- D) Everyone has perfect information

ANS: D) Everyone has perfect information

10. What does "information asymmetry" describe, and what example does the deck give?

- A) Both parties have identical information, as in a perfect market
- B) A firm with enough influence to set the market price, as with Standard Oil
- C) One party exploits knowledge the other lacks, as in predatory lending
- D) Consequences that affect unrelated third parties, as with pollution

ANS: C) One party exploits knowledge the other lacks, as in predatory lending

11. Into how many companies did the US break up Standard Oil, the deck's example of addressing monopolies?

- A) 12
- B) 7
- C) 34
- D) 50

ANS: C) 34

12. Which of the following is listed as a way to address or internalize externalities?

- A) Litigation and liability, defined property rights, and taxation
- B) Mergers, rationing, and censorship of market information
- C) Secret contracts, price fixing, and the formation of monopolies
- D) Open weights, subsidies, and aggressive advertising campaigns

ANS: A) Litigation and liability, defined property rights, and taxation

13. What does the Gini coefficient measure?

- A) A nation's total economic output over one year
- B) The number of firms competing within a market
- C) The average life expectancy of the population
- D) How a nation's income or wealth is distributed

ANS: D) How a nation's income or wealth is distributed

14. Why does the deck say that GDP is not social wellbeing?

- A) It counts only those goods and services that people say they dislike
- B) It always falls whenever the level of automation in the economy rises
- C) It directly measures how happy and satisfied the whole population is
- D) Many socially valuable tasks, like parenting, are not captured by it

ANS: D) Many socially valuable tasks, like parenting, are not captured by it

15. Which account of wellbeing is also called hedonism?

- A) Wellbeing as a set of objective goods such as knowledge
- B) Wellbeing as the balance of pleasure over pain
- C) Wellbeing as the satisfaction of preferences and desires
- D) Wellbeing as the rate of economic growth

ANS: B) Wellbeing as the balance of pleasure over pain

16. Which kind of preference is simply what people choose, and what is one of its drawbacks?

- A) Revealed preference; weakness of will
- B) Stated preference; weakness of will
- C) Idealized preference; manipulation by others cannot occur
- D) Revealed preference; it always reflects fully informed choices

ANS: A) Revealed preference; weakness of will

17. What are idealized preferences?

- A) What a fully informed person would choose
- B) What people say their preferences are
- C) What people actually choose in practice
- D) What an AI system predicts the average person prefers

ANS: A) What a fully informed person would choose

18. What is the "wireheading" problem in the happiness section?

- A) Happiness cannot be represented by any kind of mathematical function
- B) An AI might stimulate people into happiness without regard to what they value
- C) AIs refuse to take any action that could improve the happiness of humans
- D) People become happier only when their income increases in a given year

ANS: B) An AI might stimulate people into happiness without regard to what they value

19. In the discussion of moral uncertainty, what does "credence" mean?

- A) The legal authority that a moral theory holds in the courts of a country
- B) The probability an individual assigns to a moral theory being true
- C) The amount of utility that an action produces for the people it affects
- D) The number of people in a society who currently endorse a particular theory

ANS: B) The probability an individual assigns to a moral theory being true

20. What does the Moral Parliament approach do?

- A) Treating the decision as a negotiation among several moral views
- B) Supporting only the theory in which one has the highest credence
- C) Letting citizens vote on every individual AI decision
- D) Computing the highest average moral value under one single theory

ANS: A) Treating the decision as a negotiation among several moral views